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## HS 527: Indian Social Structure and Development

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| Course Code   | HS 527                                                           |
| Course Name   | Indian Social Structure and Development                          |
| L-T-P-C       | 3-0-0-3                                                          |
| Prerequisites | None                                                             |
| Intended for  | Post graduate students, 3rd and 4th Year B.Tech.                 |
| Distribution  | Core course for M.A. in Development Studies, Elective for others |
| Approval      | 23rd BoA (Apr 2018); 16th Senate (Apr 2018)                      |

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### Course Contents

- **Module I: Understanding Indian Society** [6 Lectures]
  - Perspectives to understand Indian society: Orientalist; Nationalist; Subaltern; Postcolonial
  - Indian society: Socio-spatial dimension
    - \* Rural, Urban and Rural-urban Continuum.
- **Module II: Constituents of Indian Society**
  - **Caste in India** [6 Lectures]
    - \* Understanding caste among Hindu and other religious communities
    - \* Debates on Caste: Brahminical and Non-Brahminical
    - \* Dynamics of Caste in Cities
    - \* Politics and Caste: Vote bank politics; Political Parties; Politicization of caste
    - \* Changing dynamics of caste system: Caste as structure and Caste as substance
  - **Tribes of India** [4 Lectures]
    - \* Popular and social scientific understandings of tribe and tribal community
    - \* Tribes in colonial times: Criminal Tribes, De-notified and Nomadic tribe
    - \* Developmental programs and transformations in tribal society
    - \* Tribal movements: colonial and post-independence era
  - **Class** [4 Lectures]
    - \* Issues of identification of class in India
    - \* Structure of Agrarian Class
    - \* Indian Middle Classes: Origins, Structure, Politics
    - \* Poor as class
  - \* **Gender** [4 Lectures]
    - \* Sex, Gender and Third Gender
    - \* Gender socialization and gender inequality
    - \* Patriarchy, production and women workforce in Indian economy
    - \* Women Empowerment: idea, debate and politics
- **Module III: Village in India** [6 Lectures]
  - Villages in India: popular imaginations and social scientific understandings
  - Village Studies and Community Development Program
  - Rural Development in Post-Independent India: Plans, Programs and Policies
  - Indian Villages: Change and Continuity
- **Module IV: City and Urban Space in India** [6 Lectures]
  - Understanding urbanization and urbanism
  - The Urban Turn
  - Urban stratification and Urban Public Space

- Slums in India: issues and problems
- Urban Development since Independence: Plans, Programs, Policies
- **Module V: Religion and Development** [6 Lectures]
  - Religion and Imaginations of Modern Society
  - Religious Minorities: Issues of Representation and Development
  - Secularism, communalism and fundamentalism

### Text Books

1. Deshpande, Satish., **Contemporary India: A Sociological View**, Penguin Books, 2003.
2. Gupta, Dipankar (ed)., **Social Stratification in India**, Oxford University Press, 1992.

### References

1. Cohn, B.S. 1987. 'Notes on the history of the study of Indian society and culture' [Chapter-7] in An anthropologist among the historians and other essays. New Delhi: OUP; pp: 136-171.
2. Danagare, D.N. 2007. Practising Sociology through History: The Indian Experience I and Part II. Economic and Political Weekly. Vol. 42, No. 33, pp. 3414-3421; and Vol. 42, No. 34, 3499-3508.
3. Embree, A.T. and M. Juergensmeyer. 1989. Imagining India: Essays in Indian history. New Delhi: OUP [Introduction; and Chapters-3, 11 & 12].
4. Gandhi, Leela. 1998. Postcolonial Theory: A Critical Introduction. Pp. 1-22 and 167-176. New Delhi: Oxford University Press.
5. Inden, Ronald. 2006. Text and Practice: Essays on South Asian History. [Chapter 1. Orientalist constructions of India. (pp 13-60)]. New Delhi: Oxford University Press.
6. Mongia, Padmini. (ed.). 1997. Contemporary Postcolonial Theory: A Reader. New Delhi: Oxford University Press. Pp. 1-9.
7. Oommen, T.K. 2005. 'Understanding Indian society: The relevance of the perspective from below' in S.M. Dahiwalé (ed) Understanding Indian society: The non-Brahmanic perspective. Jaipur. Rawat; pp: 33-50.
8. Dahiwalé, S.M. 2005. Understanding Indian society: The non-Brahmanic perspective. Jaipur. Rawat. (Chapter-1).
9. Ambedkar, B.R. 2002 [1936]. 'Castes in India' in Valerian Rodrigues (ed) The essential writings of B.R. Ambedkar. New Delhi: OUP; pp: 241-262.
10. Desai, Sonalde and Amaresh Dubey. 2011. Caste in 21st Century India: Competing Narratives. Economic and Political Weekly. 46(11): 40-49.
11. Ghurye, G.S. 1992. 'Features of the caste system' in Dipankar Gupta (ed) Social Stratification in India. New Delhi. OUP; pp: 35-48.
12. Fuller, C.J. 1992. Kerala Christians and the caste system. In Dipankar Gupta (ed.) Social Stratification in India. Delhi: Oxford University Press, pp: 195-212.
13. Bokil, M. 2002. De-notified and Nomadic Tribes: A Perspective. Economic and Political Weekly. Vol. 37(2): 148-154.
14. Guha, Ramachandra. 1996. Savaging the civilised: Verrier Elwin and the tribal question in late colonial India. Economic and Political Weekly. Vol. 31, No. 35/37; pp:2375-2380, 2382-2383, 2385-2389.
15. Xaxa, Virginius. 1999. Transformation of tribes in India. Terms of Discourse. Economic and Political Weekly. Vol. 34(24): 1519-1524.